

[Lesson 25](#): “Not My Will, But Thine Be Done”

Purpose: To strengthen our testimonies that we can receive forgiveness, peace, and eternal life because of the Atonement of Jesus Christ.

➡ 1. Orson F. Whitney

➡ 2. President Ezra Taft Benson

1. The Savior takes upon himself our sins and infirmities.

- [Matthew 26:36-46](#); [Mark 14:32-42](#); and [Luke 22:39-46](#) The Garden of Gethsemane

How does prayer strengthen us against temptation?

How might the command to watch, or stay awake, apply to us as we strive to live the gospel?

- See [Alma 32:26-27](#)

What can we learn from the Savior’s prayer in Gethsemane?

How have you been blessed as you have submitted to Heavenly Father’s will?

“After Jesus said that he would do Heavenly Father’s will, “there appeared an angel unto him from heaven, strengthening him” (Luke 22:43). (*Lesson Manual*)

What can this teach us about our Heavenly Father?

What did the Savior experience in Gethsemane?

- See [D&C 19:16-19](#); [Luke 22:44](#); [Mosiah 3:7](#); [Alma 7:11-13](#)

➡ 3. Elder James E. Talmage

➡ 4. Elder Neal A. Maxwell

2. We need the Atonement of Jesus Christ.

Why do we need the Atonement of Jesus Christ? See [Alma 34:9](#)

- [Moses 6:48](#) “Because of the Fall of Adam and Eve, we are subject to physical death ...”
- [1 Nephi 10:21](#) “Our sins make us unclean and unable to dwell with God.”
- [John 3:16](#); [2 Nephi 2:5-9](#) “Because we cannot overcome physical or spiritual death by ourselves, ...”

What blessings are available to us because of the Savior’s atoning sacrifice?

- [Mosiah 16:7-8](#) “... the sting of death is swallowed up in Christ.”
- [Alma 7:13-14](#); “... that he might take upon him the sins of his people ...”
- [Alma 7:11-12](#) “... he will take upon him the pains and the sicknesses of his people ...”
- [D&C 19:23](#) “Learn of me, ... and you shall have peace in me.”

➡ 5. Elder Marion G. Romney

([The Life and Teachings of Jesus and His Apostles](#): *Course Manual (Religion 211-212)*.)

Next Week: New Testament Lesson 26: “To This End Was I Born”

Matthew 26:47—27:66; Mark 14:43—15:39; Luke 22:47—23:56; John 18--19 ➡ •



➡ **1. Orson F. Whitney:** He received a vision a few years before he was ordained an Apostle. “I seemed to be in the Garden of Gethsemane, a witness of the Savior’s agony. I saw him as plainly as ever I have seen anyone. Standing behind a tree in the foreground, I beheld Jesus, with Peter, James and John, as they came through a little ... gate at my right. Leaving the three Apostles there, after telling them to kneel and pray, the Son of God passed over to the other side, where He also knelt and prayed. It was the same prayer with which all Bible readers are familiar: ‘Oh my Father, if it be possible, let this cup pass from me; nevertheless not as I will, but as thou wilt.’

“As He prayed the tears streamed down his face, which was toward me. I was so moved at the sight that I also wept, out of pure sympathy. My whole heart went out to him; I loved him with all my soul, and longed to be with him as I longed for nothing else.

“Presently He arose and walked to where those Apostles were kneeling—fast asleep! He shook them gently, awoke them, and in a tone of tender reproach, untinctured by the least show of anger or impatience, asked them plaintively if they could not watch with him one hour. There He was, with the awful weight of the world’s sin upon his shoulders, with the pangs of every man, woman and child shooting through his sensitive soul—and they could not watch with him one poor hour!

“Returning to his place, He offered up the same prayer as before; then went back and again found them sleeping. Again he awoke them, readmonished them, and once more returned and prayed. Three times this occurred” (*Through Memory’s Halls* [1930], 82).

➡ **2. President Ezra Taft Benson:** “In Gethsemane and on Calvary, He worked out the infinite and eternal atonement. It was the greatest single act of love in recorded history. Thus He became our Redeemer—redeeming all of us from physical death, and redeeming those of us from spiritual death who will obey the laws and ordinances of the gospel.” (*The Teachings of Ezra Taft Benson* [1988], 14)

➡ **3. Elder James E. Talmage:** “Christ’s agony in the garden is unfathomable by the finite mind, both as to intensity and cause. ... He struggled and groaned under a burden such as no other being who has lived on earth might even conceive as possible. It was not physical pain, nor mental anguish alone, that caused him to suffer such torture as to produce an extrusion of blood from every pore; but a spiritual agony of soul such as only

God was capable of experiencing. ... In that hour of anguish Christ met and overcame all the horrors that Satan, ‘the prince of this world,’ could inflict. ... In some manner, actual and terribly real though to man incomprehensible, the Savior took upon Himself the burden of the sins of mankind from Adam to the end of the world.” (*Jesus the Christ*, 3rd ed. [1916], 613)

➡ **4. Elder Neal A. Maxwell:** “As part of His infinite atonement, Jesus knows ‘according to the flesh’ all that through which we pass. ([Alma 7:11–12](#)). He has borne the sins, griefs, sorrows, and ... pains of every man, woman, and child (see [2 Nephi 9:21](#)).” (“[Overcome ... Even As I Also Overcame](#),” *Ensign*, May 1987, 72)

➡ **5. Elder Marion G. Romney:** “It took the atonement of Jesus Christ to reunite the bodies and spirits of men in the resurrection. And so all the world, believers and non-believers, are indebted to the Redeemer for their certain resurrection, because the resurrection will be as wide as was the fall, which brought death to every man.

“There is another phase of the atonement which makes me love the Savior even more, and fills my soul with gratitude beyond expression. It is that in addition to atoning for Adam’s transgression, thereby bringing about the resurrection, the Savior by his suffering paid the debt for my personal sins. He paid the debt for your personal sins and for the personal sins of every living soul that ever dwelt upon the earth or that ever will dwell in mortality upon the earth. But this he did conditionally. The benefits of this suffering for our individual transgressions will not come to us unconditionally in the same sense that the resurrection will come regardless of what we do. If we partake of the blessings of the atonement as far as our individual transgressions are concerned, we must obey the law.

“... When we commit sin, we are estranged from God and rendered unfit to enter into his presence. No unclean thing can enter into his presence. We cannot of ourselves, no matter how we may try, rid ourselves of the stain which is upon us as a result of our own transgressions. That stain must be washed away by the blood of the Redeemer, and he has set up the way by which that stain may be removed. That way is the gospel of Jesus Christ. The gospel requires us to believe in the Redeemer, accept his atonement, repent of our sins, be baptized by immersion for the remission of our sins, receive the gift of the Holy Ghost by the laying on of hands, and continue faithfully to observe, or do the best we can to observe, the principles of the gospel all the days of our lives” (in Conference Report, Oct. 1953, 35–36)